



GANESH NARAYANAN, MD & CEO, CA GRAMEEN



BFSI

NON-BANKING FINANCIAL COMPANY

→ The company has digitised field operations to reduce paper usage, eliminated plastic bottles and tissue paper at the head office and encouraged employees to carry reusable cups

→ The company is also working on setting a net-zero carbon emissions target

→ Socially, CA Grameen has made deep inroads into India's most underserved areas. Notably, the company operates in 64 of India's 112 aspirational districts

→ It trains its customers—many of them first-time tech users—on digital hygiene, while investing in cybersecurity infra

Sustainable Financing Framework.

In June 2023, the company raised \$200 million via a social syndicate loan, the first in India's microfinance sector and only the fourth such deal in the country. "It allowed us to diversify our lender base and build a track record in sustainable finance," says Narayanan. As part of its FY28 strategy, the company aims to increase its foreign funding share from 21% to 25–30%, while actively exploring green and social bonds to meet its capital needs.

Impact, for CA Grameen, isn't just a feel-good word, it's a metric. From financial literacy workshops to carbon audits, the company evaluates its efforts rigorously. For environmental metrics, Scope 1, 2, and 3 emissions are tracked regularly, aligned with IFC performance standards. Social outcomes are measured through customer surveys and third-party studies.

"Whether it's confidence in making household decisions or accessing better jobs, we want to ensure our customers are truly empowered," says Narayanan. In rural India, where financial access can transform an entire family's future, that empowerment has ripple effects far beyond the balance sheet.

As sustainability moves from a priority to an imperative, CA Grameen is positioning itself as a frontrunner in the microfinance sector. Its integrated approach—rooted in ESG principles and backed by data—makes it a blend of scale, sincerity, and strategy. CA Grameen has won the Sustainability Leadership Award (NBFC) not just because their measures are good for the planet or good for people—but because they make business sense. And in India's vast, underserved hinterland that might just be the blueprint for lasting change. **BT**

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